

Preparing for Biospecimen Collections

7.1 Overview

When a study participant agrees to provide at least one of the biospecimens collected in this study (i.e. saliva, blood, or stool) a biospecimen Master Kit must be assigned to the woman. Study Staff will ensure the components of each Master Kit are correctly labeled, and that the correct biospecimen forms are completed by the appropriate study staff member or other hospital staff (e.g. phlebotomist, surgical staff, or pathologist) for each specimen collection procedure. Careful coordination by the study managers, interviewers, and other hospital staff will be required to ensure that the biospecimens are collected and processed in a timely manner according to the procedures provided (refer to Chapters 8 - 11).

7.2 Assignment of a Master Kit to a Participant in the Study

A participant will be assigned a Master Kit only if she has given signed informed consent to provide at least one of these biospecimens: saliva, blood, or stool. Study Staff will link a biospecimen Master Kit labeled with a unique Sample ID to the Participant ID (PID) using procedures developed locally. The link should be made after eligibility has been confirmed and after the participant has agreed to provide at least one biospecimen (blood, saliva, or stool) to avoid unnecessarily wasting kits.

Each Master Kit has a unique Sample ID. Sample IDs all begin with the letters GBR and are followed by five numeric digits, e.g. GBR12345. Sample IDs identify biospecimen kits and components as well as forms used for the collection of biospecimens for the study.

Each hospital has been assigned its own range of Sample IDs:

Korle-Bu Teaching Hospital (KBTH): GBR00001 to GBR02499

Komfo Anokye Teaching Hospital (KATH): GBR02501 to GBR04999

Peace and Love Hospital (PLH): GBR05001 to GBR07499

7.3 Contents of the Biospecimen Master Kit

The biospecimen Master Kit includes three separate bags. Each bag has a round colored circle label on it. The blue, red or yellow circle label indicates for which collection activity it will be used. The bag with the blue label is for the saliva collection. The bag with the red label is for the blood collection, and inside the blood collection kit is a blood processing kit with a green label on it. The bag with a yellow label is for the stool collection. . Cosmetic bags have been provided separately and are intended to hold all the components of the stool collection kit to be given to the participant. For detailed instructions about the contents of each bag in the Master Kit and how to use it, refer to Chapter 8-10.

The Master Kit includes the forms necessary for collecting and processing the saliva, stool, and blood samples:

- Blood Collection Form (printed on pink paper)
- Saliva Collection Form (printed on blue paper)
- Stool Collection Form (printed on yellow paper)

The forms are pre-labeled with the Sample IDs assigned to the kit and specimen collection materials. After a Master Kit and its associated Sample ID are assigned to a participant, the Study Manager or Interviewer must place the participant's PID label on each biospecimen form in the Master Kit. This should be done before any samples are collected. The Study Manager must also record the Sample ID in the Recruitment Tracking Log (Appendix 2-1). At the bottom of each form page is a control number. If a multipage form is separated, the control number should be used to re-join the pages of the form for a participant.

The tubes and vials have been pre-labeled with a specimen ID label that includes the Sample ID plus four additional numbers called the sequence number (e.g. GBR12345 0011). Other than placing the PID on each form, no additional labeling is required by clinic, hospital, or laboratory staff.

The Master Kit does not contain any supplies for collecting breast biopsy tissue from participants. Supplies for collecting and processing breast biopsy tissue are maintained at each hospital. A PID label must be placed on the Breast Biopsy Form. The Breast Biopsy Form should be added to the participant's file if the participant is a Case and has agreed to allow the study to obtain part of the

tissue collected during biopsy. Procedures specific to the breast tissue biopsy are described in Chapter 11.

7.4 Verifying Biospecimen Labels

Before collecting biospecimens from participants, the Study Manager or Interviewer must verify that all components in the Master Kit are consistently labeled with the same Sample ID.

Saliva Kit - Blue Circle

Saliva Kit ID	GBR#####	SV01
Saliva Collection Tube	GBR#####	1101

Stool Kit- Yellow Circle

Stool Kit ID	GBR#####	SX01
Stool Collection Tube 1	GBR#####	2011
Stool Collection Tube 2	GBR#####	2012

Blood Collection Kit- Red Circle

Blood Collection Kit ID	GBR#####	BK01
Red Top Tube ID	GBR#####	RT01
Purple Top Tube ID	GBR#####	PT01

Blood Processing Kit ID - Green Circle

Blood Processing Kit ID	GBR#####	PK01
Cryovial 1 for Plasma	GBR#####	0011
Cryovial 2 for Plasma	GBR#####	0012
Cryovial 3 for Plasma	GBR#####	0013
Cryovial for Buffy Coat	GBR#####	0021
Cryovial 1 Red Blood Cells	GBR#####	0031
Cryovial 2 Red Blood Cells	GBR#####	0032
Cryovial 1 for Serum	GBR#####	0041
Cryovial 2 for Serum	GBR#####	0042
Cryovial 3 for Serum	GBR#####	0043
Cryovial for Blood Clot	GBR#####	0051

If any of the contents in the Master Kit are not correctly labeled, the entire Master Kit should be discarded and a new Master Kit must be assigned to a participant. A participant should never be assigned two different Sample IDs. If a new Master Kit is assigned to a participant, then the previously assigned Sample ID must be unlinked from the PID and the new one linked to the PID on the Recruitment Tracking Log as well as on the biospecimen forms. The old Sample ID should

not be used again. The Study Manager should notify Westat of any incorrectly labeled Master Kit along with the Sample ID.

7.5 Proceeding with Biospecimen Collections

Once the Sample ID has been assigned to the participant and the contents of the Master Kit have been verified, then the biospecimens can be collected according to the procedures outlined in Chapters 8 -10. The study staff member who conducted the Risk Factor Questionnaire interview (the Interviewer, Assistant Study Manager, or Study Manager) is responsible for collecting the saliva, completing the Saliva Form, assembling/distributing the Stool Collection Kit and explaining the stool collection procedures to the participant.

Blood should be collected only by a phlebotomist at each hospital who was trained in January 2013 to use the contents of the Blood Collection Kit and to complete the appropriate sections of the Blood Collection and Processing Form. Similarly, blood should be processed only by a laboratory technician at each hospital who was trained in January 2013 to use the contents of the Blood Processing Kit and to complete the appropriate sections of the Blood Collection and Processing Form.

Given the various clinic and hospital staff required to successfully collect all the biospecimens in this study, daily communication and coordination with different departments in each hospital will be necessary. Interviewers and Study Managers will be responsible for maintaining coordination with these departments.